

INTERNAL

Termination and Asset Return Policy

ISO 27001 Control 5.11 - Return of Assets

Document ID: ISMS-POL-TERM-001	Version: 3.0
Effective Date: January 1, 2025	Review Date: January 1, 2026
Owner: Human Resources & IT Security	Approved By: Chief Information Security Officer

Version	Date	Author	Changes
1.0	January 2023	HR Director	Initial policy creation
2.0	June 2024	CISO	Added remote work assets and data protection requirements
3.0	January 2025	CISO / HR Director	Enhanced procedures for contractors and third parties; added digital asset return process

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1. Purpose

This policy establishes the requirements and procedures for the return of all organizational assets upon termination, resignation, role change, or conclusion of employment contract or agreement with personnel, contractors, consultants, and other interested parties. The policy ensures that:

- All organizational assets are properly accounted for and returned
- Confidential and sensitive information is protected
- Access to systems, facilities, and data is promptly revoked
- The organization maintains control over its physical and digital assets
- Compliance with legal, regulatory, and contractual obligations is maintained

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

- **Personnel:** All full-time, part-time, and temporary employees
- **Contractors:** Independent contractors, consultants, and temporary workers
- **Third Parties:** Vendors, suppliers, partners, and service providers with access to organizational assets
- **Situations:** Employment termination (voluntary or involuntary), resignation, retirement, role changes, contract expiration, or end of engagement

⚠ **Important:** This policy covers both voluntary and involuntary terminations, including disciplinary dismissals, redundancies, resignations, retirements, end of fixed-term contracts, and role changes requiring different access levels.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 General Requirements

- All organizational assets in the possession of personnel and other interested parties must be returned upon change or termination of employment, contract, or agreement
- Asset return must be completed before or on the last working day, or as specified in the termination agreement
- Personnel are responsible for returning assets in good working condition, accounting for normal wear and tear
- Final compensation, references, or contract closure may be withheld until all assets are returned
- The organization reserves the right to pursue recovery of unreturned assets through legal means if necessary

3.2 Confidentiality and Data Protection

- All confidential information and data must remain confidential after termination
- Personnel must delete or return all copies of organizational data from personal devices
- Non-disclosure obligations continue beyond the termination of employment or contract
- Unauthorized retention or use of organizational information may result in legal action

3.3 Access Revocation

- All access rights to systems, applications, facilities, and networks must be revoked promptly
- Credentials (passwords, tokens, keys, badges) must be deactivated on or before the last working day
- Remote access capabilities must be disabled immediately upon termination notification

4. Asset Categories

4.1 Physical Assets

Asset Type	Examples	Return Requirements
IT Equipment	Laptops, desktop computers, tablets, monitors, keyboards, mice, docking stations, webcams, headsets	Return in original or equivalent packaging if available; must be functional
Mobile Devices	Company-issued smartphones, mobile hotspots, SIM cards, portable chargers	Factory reset not required (IT will perform); return with chargers and accessories
Access Cards & Keys	Building access cards, office keys, parking permits, security tokens, cabinet keys	Return all access credentials on last working day
Office Equipment	Furniture (if personally assigned), printers, scanners, projectors, presentation equipment	Return or arrangements made for collection
Vehicles	Company cars, fleet vehicles, parking permits	Return clean and fueled; schedule handover inspection
Documents & Materials	Files, records, manuals, policies, client information, proprietary documents, notebooks	Return all physical and electronic copies; verify no copies retained
Credit Cards & Financial	Corporate credit cards, expense cards, fuel cards, procurement cards	Return and settle all outstanding expenses
Uniforms & PPE	Branded clothing, safety equipment, protective gear, tools	Return clean and in reasonable condition

Asset Type	Examples	Return Requirements
Other Assets	Software licenses (physical), library books, samples, prototypes, marketing materials	Return as specified by asset owner

4.2 Digital Assets and Access

Asset Type	Examples	Action Required
Email & Communications	Email accounts, voicemail, instant messaging accounts, video conferencing	Access revoked; out-of-office message configured; emails forwarded as appropriate
System Access	Network accounts, VPN access, cloud services, databases, applications	All accounts deactivated; multi-factor authentication disabled
Data & Files	Documents, spreadsheets, presentations, code, databases, customer data	Transfer ownership; delete personal copies; ensure backup completed
Credentials	Passwords, API keys, SSH keys, certificates, security tokens	All credentials changed or revoked; documented and transferred to authorized personnel
Cloud Storage	OneDrive, SharePoint, Google Drive, Dropbox (company accounts)	Access removed; content transferred to manager or archived
Social Media & External	Company social media accounts, third-party tools, client portals	Admin access removed; accounts transferred to designated personnel
Intellectual Property	Code repositories, designs, patents, trademarks, proprietary methodologies	Ownership confirmed with organization; all copies deleted from personal devices

⚠ **Personal Devices:** Any organizational data stored on personal devices (under BYOD policy) must be securely deleted. IT may require verification of deletion or remote wipe of company data partitions.

5. Termination Procedures

5.1 Standard Termination Timeline

Termination Process Flow

1 Notice Period Begins

Timing: Upon resignation submission or termination notice

Actions:

- HR notifies IT Security and relevant departments
- Asset inventory list generated for departing individual
- Exit interview scheduled
- Knowledge transfer plan initiated

2 Pre-Departure Period (1-2 weeks before last day)

Timing: 1-2 weeks before final working day

Actions:

- Manager confirms asset inventory with employee
- IT begins data backup and transfer process
- Finance confirms expense settlements
- Security reviews access rights and credentials
- Employee provided with Asset Return Checklist

3 Final Week

Timing: Last 5 working days

Actions:

- Employee returns physical assets to IT/Facilities
- Manager reviews file transfers and handovers
- Exit interview conducted by HR
- Final expense claims submitted and approved
- Corporate credit cards returned

4 Last Working Day

Timing: Final day of employment

Actions:

- All remaining physical assets returned
- Access cards and keys surrendered
- IT confirms receipt of all equipment
- Employee signs Asset Return Confirmation Form
- Final security briefing on confidentiality obligations

5 Post-Departure (End of last working day)

Timing: After employee leaves

Actions:

- IT immediately disables all system access
- Email account converted to shared mailbox or forwarding set up
- Network credentials deactivated
- Remote access and VPN disabled

- Building access cards deactivated
- Manager confirms knowledge transfer completion

6 Post-Departure Review (1-2 days after)

Timing: 1-2 business days after last day

Actions:

- IT audits all access removals
- HR confirms all assets received and documented
- Finance processes final payment
- Outstanding assets flagged for recovery if necessary

5.2 Immediate Termination Procedures

In cases of immediate termination (disciplinary dismissal, gross misconduct, security breach):

Immediate Actions Required:

- Employee escorted from premises immediately
- All assets collected on the spot before departure
- IT disables all access within 30 minutes of termination notification
- Personal belongings retrieved under supervision
- Security informed and building access immediately revoked
- If remote worker: IT remotely wipes devices or locks access; shipping labels provided for asset return within 48 hours
- Legal team notified if sensitive information access was involved

5.3 Remote Worker Termination

For employees working remotely or in different locations:

- Asset return must be completed within 5 business days of termination
- Pre-paid shipping labels provided by the organization
- Tracking numbers required for all shipments
- Assets must be packaged securely to prevent damage
- Remote wipe of mobile devices may be performed if not returned promptly
- Video call may be required to verify destruction of documents if return is not feasible

6. Asset Return Process

6.1 Asset Return Checklist

IT Equipment & Devices

- ☐ Laptop computer (with charger and accessories)

- ☐ Desktop computer (monitor, keyboard, mouse)

- ☐ Mobile phone/smartphone (with charger)

- ☐ Tablet device (with charger and accessories)

- ☐ Docking station

- ☐ External hard drives or USB drives

- ☐ Headset/webcam/other peripherals

- ☐ Any other IT equipment issued

Access & Security

- ☐ Building access card/badge

- ☐ Office keys

- ☐ Parking permit/access card

- ☐ Security tokens (RSA, YubiKey, etc.)

- ☐ Cabinet/locker keys
-

Financial & Credit

- ☐ Corporate credit card
-
- ☐ Fuel card/expense card
-
- ☐ All expense reports submitted and approved
-

Documents & Information

- ☐ All physical files and documents
-
- ☐ Notebooks and written materials
-
- ☐ Client information and contact lists
-
- ☐ Proprietary or confidential documents
-
- ☐ Confirm deletion of company data from personal devices
-

Other Assets

- ☐ Company vehicle (if applicable)
-
- ☐ Uniforms or branded clothing
-
- ☐ Tools or specialized equipment
-
- ☐ Library books or training materials
-
- ☐ Any other company property
-

Digital Assets & Access

- ☐ Confirm file transfers to manager/team completed
- ☐ Document passwords/credentials for shared accounts
- ☐ Transfer ownership of key documents and projects
- ☐ Remove personal data from company systems
- ☐ Confirm social media account access transferred

6.2 Asset Condition and Inspection

Upon return, assets will be inspected for:

- **Functionality:** Device powers on and operates correctly
- **Physical Condition:** No significant damage beyond normal wear and tear
- **Completeness:** All components, accessories, and chargers included
- **Data Security:** No unauthorized software or modifications

Acceptable Wear and Tear: Minor scratches, worn keys, fading of materials due to regular use

Unacceptable Damage: Cracked screens, water damage, missing components, physical abuse, unauthorized modifications

6.3 Asset Return Confirmation

The following documentation must be completed:

Asset Return Confirmation Form

This form must be signed by both the departing individual and the receiving party (IT or HR representative) and includes:

- Complete list of assets returned with serial numbers
- Condition assessment for each item
- Date and time of return
- Signatures of both parties